

Jeter Cotton

Director of Project Management | Agency Delivery & Operations | AI Workflow Automation

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Summary

Project management leader with nearly 9 years of agency experience, growing from Project Manager to Director and building the PM function from the ground up. Now runs delivery for 60+ clients (about \$4M a year) with a team of 3 PMs. Happiest turning messy operations into simple systems, like cutting non-billable hours by 20%+ and building 9 AI agents that handle utilization reporting and flag at-risk clients early.

Experience

Primitive — Lubbock, TX · Dec 2017–Present

Marketing and digital services agency · 30+ employees · 60+ active clients

Director of Project Management · Nov 2025–Present

Lead Project Manager · Jul 2024–Nov 2025

- Run delivery for 60+ active clients (about \$4M in annual revenue), and hire, lead, and coach a team of 3 Project Managers who each carry about 20 clients.
- Cut non-billable hours by 20%+ after rebuilding capacity planning and work assignment across 19 billable team members (about 1,100 hours of capacity per sprint).
- Designed the Client Sentiment Monitor, an AI agent that reads ClickUp chats, task comments, and client email to gauge relationship health. Its weekly red/yellow/green check of 56 accounts caught a \$16.6K/month retainer early enough to pull it back from red to yellow.
- Built 9 AI agents in ClickUp and Claude that handle utilization reporting, billable-time audits, sprint rollovers, time-tracking reminders, meeting notes, and project intake, saving the team 15+ hours a week of manual admin.
- Built the PM department from zero, defining roles, the intake-to-delivery workflow, and performance metrics now used by 30+ staff across 7 departments.
- Co-lead the 2026 Billable Utilization initiative (80% company target) and work with executive leadership on staffing, resourcing, and process priorities.
- Built the capacity and utilization dashboards leadership uses to plan sprints and forecast workload across 7 teams.
- Led the company-wide move from Slack to ClickUp Chat for 30+ staff in about 6 weeks, using internal champions, short training videos, and a dedicated support channel. Client channels stayed live the whole time.
- Rebuilt web project delivery into a 7-phase, 39-step process with 5 client approval gates and automatic escalation after 3 revision rounds. Adopted company-wide, it ended ad hoc handoffs and wasted copy rework.

Lead Account Manager · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

- Managed 40 client accounts worth about \$1.14M a year as the main contact for strategy, scope, and escalations.
- Kept 95% of accounts year over year and landed about 10 upsells and scope expansions worth \$50K combined.

Product Owner / Senior Product Owner · Sep 2020–Nov 2022

- Owned the backlog and roadmap for 35 software and website projects, leading a 6-person team (content strategist, copywriter, designer, and 3 developers) in 1-week sprints.
- Shipped about 70 releases, 90% of them on time, and was promoted to Senior Product Owner within 19 months.
- Standardized how projects were structured and set up time tracking by discipline (strategy, copy, design, development), giving the team its first clear view of where hours went.

Project Manager · Dec 2017–Sep 2020

- Delivered about 65 client projects a year, with budgets up to \$15K, 90% on time and on budget.
- Introduced consistent time tracking across project teams, something the agency had never done before.

Technical Director / A/V Coordinator · Redeemer Church; Indiana Avenue Baptist Church · 2013–2017

- Ran weekly live production (audio, lighting, video, and livestream), trained a volunteer crew of 20+, and wrote the SOPs that kept it consistent.

Skills

Project & program management: Portfolio Management, Resource Management, Capacity Planning, Agile/Scrum, Scope & Budget Management, Risk Management, Stakeholder Management, PMO Setup

Operations: Process Improvement, Change Management, KPI & Utilization Reporting, AI Workflow Automation, Team Leadership & Hiring

Tools: ClickUp, Jira, Asana, HubSpot, Claude, Google Workspace, Figma

Education & Certifications

Associate of Applied Science, Sound Technology — South Plains College